Information classification — the nature of each item is tagged throughout this report FACT Official / public / confirmed FIELD Customer statements on site ANALYSIS IMIT/IMIE analysis / hypothesis PROPOSAL Proposal OPEN Unconfirmed / follow-up

WARSZAWA REGION, POLAND — ENERGY INFRASTRUCTURE FLEET

PGE GROUP × ISUZU

PGE Group Fleet Customer Visit Report

Pickup fleet usage, procurement process, D-MAX evaluation and the upcoming tender (customer interview record)

MEETING	VISITED	ATTENDEES
Pickup fleet interview: procurement, vehicle requirements, after-sales	PGE Group (distribution network arm) Regional branch (name / entity to be confirmed)	Customer: fleet operations managers Isuzu: IMIT (Thailand) team, Astara

0 Executive Summary

The single most important objective is to win the upcoming tender for approx. 150 Extended Cab units. PGE buys around 150 units roughly every two years, followed by 20–40 add-on units in the following years. Responding only after publication will be too late; preparation starts now, together with Astara Poland.

The customer is a regional branch of the distribution network arm of **PGE Group** (Poland's largest energy group, majority state-owned), responsible for maintaining, repairing, renewing and providing emergency response for the power network. Pickups are not mere transport but the field crews' **"mobile work base"** — heavy loads, short trips, long idling and 24-hour readiness make for a severe duty cycle.

FIELD Around 600 pickups (D-MAX, Mitsubishi L200) are in daily use company-wide, with vehicles of 13 to 20+ years to be replaced mainly within the next five years. Purchasing runs through transparent company-wide tenders; price is the main criterion, with warranty, service, TCO and document quality also assessed. FACT Per Isuzu sales records, **200+ D-MAX have been delivered to PGE over recent years**; the existing fleet also includes Ford Ranger and Toyota Hilux in large numbers.

ANALYSIS The customer excludes Chinese-built vehicles under critical-infrastructure procurement. With no EU-built pickups and US models oversized, the **Thai-built D-MAX is one of the few options meeting "non-Chinese, European-size 4x4 workhorse"**, leaving Toyota, Ford and few others as the effective competition.

PROPOSAL To win the tender, five things should be prepared first: (1) continuous monitoring of the procurement platform, (2) an extended warranty / service package that can be written into tender requirements, (3) DPF measures for short-trip / long-idling use, (4) continued Extended / Single Cab and manual availability, (5) 10-year TCO material (details in ch. 12–13).

~150
Upcoming tender volume
Extended Cab; publication expected soon (approx. 2-year cycle plus 20–40 add-on units)

200+
D-MAX delivered to PGE
Cumulative over recent years (Isuzu sales records); Ford and Toyota also in the fleet

~600
Pickups in daily use, company-wide
Approx. 107 at the visited branch (regional branch, ~1,000 employees)

10+ yrs
Service life (internal target)
Actual fleet includes 13- and 20+-year-old vehicles; replacement due within 5 years

1 Background and Purpose

The Isuzu side explained that the visitors came from the export company in Thailand, to hear frank views on sales, product and after-sales, work on improvements together with factory and R&D colleagues, and ultimately deliver better products to customers.

FACT This is the **PGE Group visit** planned at the previous day's Astara Poland meeting. PGE (Polska Grupa Energetyczna) is Poland's largest energy group, majority-owned by the State Treasury, with about 40% of domestic generation; its distribution subsidiary PGE Dystrybucja serves about 5.7 million customers, the largest in Poland (central / eastern regions). OPEN The gap versus the "8–10 million clients / users" mentioned in the meeting, and which legal entity / branch was visited, remain to be confirmed.

2 Customer Profile — Distribution Network Operator

- FIELD Operates, maintains, repairs, rebuilds and renews the **distribution network** for households and industry, including emergency field response, serving around 8–10 million clients / users daily; the visited branch has around 1,000 employees. OPEN Figures to be verified (PGE Dystrybucja publishes ~5.7 million customers).
- FACT A 100% subsidiary within PGE Group; the group is listed, with the State Treasury as majority shareholder.
- **Not the electricity sales company.** Regulatory unbundling separates network operation from electricity sales even within the same group; the company cannot freely sell electricity or operate charging services. Its role is limited to owning, managing, maintaining and rebuilding the network.
- Undergrounding of lines is gaining importance (less tree-cutting and weather exposure than overhead lines) but is not possible everywhere and is judged case by case.

3 Fleet Size, Age and Replacement

- FIELD Around 600 pickups in daily use company-wide; around 107 at the visited branch, where the fleet consists of Isuzu D-MAX and Mitsubishi L200.
- FACT Per Isuzu sales records, **200+ D-MAX** have been delivered to PGE cumulatively over recent years; across PGE, a large existing pickup fleet of Ford Ranger and Toyota Hilux is also in place (gkpge.pl / Isuzu sales data).
- FIELD On site, Mitsubishi L200s two generations old (including single cab) were seen still in service, all fitted with roof beacons, "POGOTOWIE ENERGETYCZNE" (energy emergency) signage and antennas — confirming the fleet age, single-cab use and routine roof equipment in practice.
- Vehicle age reaches about 13 and 20+ years. The internal target is around 10 years of use, but this is exceeded in practice.
- Annual mileage is not necessarily high, but load and duty are severe: tools, shelving, containers, materials, clothing and equipment are carried at all times, with some vehicles at or near overload.
- **Replacement of the ageing fleet is needed mainly within the next five years.**

4 Procurement / Tender Process

- FIELD Vehicles are purchased through a **formal, transparent company-level procurement platform**; branches do not buy independently, though branch needs influence specifications. Meeting all requirements and submitting complete documentation are preconditions to bid.
- **Price is the main decision factor.** Warranty, service, maintenance, TCO, parts cost and the overall package are also considered.
- Special offers such as an extended warranty **cannot be provided privately to Isuzu only**; they must be built transparently into the tender, visible to all suppliers.
- **Document quality matters.** Poor translations, unclear comments or machine-translation artifacts create clean-up work in the customer's internal systems. Tender documents must be accurate and professional.

4.1 Budget Cycle, Timing and Stock

- FIELD Alignment with the annual budget cycle is essential: a process starting in January must be synchronised with budget planning, and ordering and budget booking can straddle two years. Production and shipping from Thailand take months, so early planning is indispensable.
- Around November, unused budget may remain, in which case purchase volumes may be increased or extended before year-end. December is the busiest month, and **the key deadline is delivery, not order placement**; the Christmas closing makes timing all the more sensitive.
- The Isuzu side explained that European distributor stock and cross-country transfers (the European team covers several markets) could serve urgent year-end demand. ANALYSIS The stock-visibility scheme Astara already operates with Germany and others is a concrete tool for exactly this demand.
- FIELD (Astara Poland information) PGE has purchased 200+ pickups over recent years, also using Toyota and others. A tender for **approx. 150 Extended Cab units** is expected to be published shortly (delivery assumed next year); the price range is known from the previous award (to be shared separately via the Focus Presentation).

5 Country-of-Production Restriction — a Protected Segment

PROTECTED SEGMENT — EXCLUSION OF CHINESE-BUILT VEHICLES

FIELD The customer stated that vehicles produced in China cannot, or can hardly, be purchased. OPEN Whether the basis is legal, internal or policy remains to be confirmed. EU-built vehicles would be ideal, but pickups are generally not produced in the EU; US production might be acceptable but the vehicles are too large for the operation.

ANALYSIS The Thai-built D-MAX is therefore one of the few options meeting "non-Chinese and European size" — a segment that JAC, Maxus and other low-price Chinese brands cannot enter, with competition limited to Toyota, Ford and few others. This is fully consistent with the critical-infrastructure exclusion confirmed at the previous day's Astara meeting.

6 Cab Type — Extended Today, Single Cab in Future

- FIELD The current preference is **Extended Cab**. Rear space serves as covered storage for clothing, tools and work items and is rarely used for passengers.
- A full double cab with three rear seats is unnecessary; utility comes before passenger comfort, although occasional rear-seat flexibility is useful. Tax treatment is not an issue, as the vehicles already receive commercial treatment.
- **A future need for Single Cab (front row only) was stated**, particularly as a base for conversions and special bodies.
- ANALYSIS This backs, from the side of real customer demand, Astara Poland's request to keep Single / Extended Cab; dropping them in the next model would mean losing this segment.

6.1 Conversion Project — Small Pickup-Based Aerial Platform

- FIELD A possible future project for small lift / aerial work platform vehicles on a pickup base was mentioned — not 40–50 m trucks, but small units for narrow urban and limited-access sites.
- Single cab is required for body space (a double cab reduces the usable bed). Initial quantity could be around 3 units, for this or another energy-related company. OPEN User and timing to be confirmed.
- Isuzu mentioned UK references for single-cab and body-built applications; **the customer said UK examples would be useful**.

7 Usage — the Pickup as a Mobile Work Base

- FIELD Pickups are more than transport: driven to network facilities, infrastructure sites and repair points, they then serve — engine running — for heating / cooling, communication, storage, rest and shelter: a **mobile work base** for field crews.
- Work runs from around 7:00 until late; in emergencies, operation is 24 hours with shift changes. A working team is usually two people; 20–40 people per region work in shifts, with three or four pickups plus other vehicles at one operating point.
- Central Poland is easy terrain, but the south is mountainous and rough. **4x4 is essential** to reach network points through snow, mud and bad weather; base equipment is kept common across regions so vehicles can work anywhere.

7.1 Load and Performance Requirements

- FIELD Heavy tools, containers, shelving, parts and equipment are carried at all times, and field teams ask for more carrying capacity. Priorities are payload, suspension strength, durability, torque, low-speed performance, hill starts, loaded driving and body strength.
- **The vehicles are work tools, not leisure cars.** Fuel consumption is not the top priority; real-world capability under heavy load, idling and short trips matters more than catalogue figures.

8 Transmission — Trust in Manual, Gradual Automatic

- FIELD Manual is preferred today: many drivers have used manuals for 30–40 years and trust them in rough, heavy use. There is concern that automatics may cause problems in severe duty, partly based on perception and older experience.
- Isuzu explained the benefits of modern automatics (more gears, drivability, torque management, off-road usability, ease of operation, off-road event results). **The customer did not reject automatic** and mentioned possible partial adoption in future — gradually, with **test drives / demos under loaded, off-road, real-use conditions** seen as important.
- ANALYSIS Keeping manual in the line-up is a must for this customer group. At the same time, designing loaded / off-road demo opportunities is the key to building AT acceptance over the medium term.

9 DPF / After-Treatment — the Top Technical Issue

RISK — DPF CLOGGING FROM SHORT TRIPS AND LONG IDLING

FIELD The typical pattern is a drive of about 10 km, a stop of 30–60 minutes, a few minutes' move, repeated — plus long idling in the mobile-base role. **Regeneration cannot complete properly and the DPF / catalyst clogs.** Cleaning may be needed every few months and is expensive; even under warranty / maintenance the customer may have to pay, as the issue is usage-related rather than a defect.

The customer understands the cause but **cannot avoid this usage pattern** — it is the job. Isuzu is expected to look into DPF support, guidance, maintenance processes and technical countermeasures for short-trip / long-idling utility use.

PROPOSAL Prepare as one package: (1) operational guidance on forced regeneration, (2) early-warning use of GPS / fleet data (ch. 11) for DPF risk, (3) an R&D review of after-treatment measures for this duty, (4) clear after-treatment service terms in tenders.

10 D-MAX Evaluation, Warranty and Parts

- FIELD "Not many problems" with Isuzu vehicles; **reliability is viewed positively**. The concern is **high maintenance / parts cost**: the perception is that Isuzu is genuine-parts-centred, with fewer non-genuine alternatives than some brands.
- Suspension and past engine-related issues were mentioned. OPEN Details, frequency, model year and failure mode to be confirmed.
- An unclear "eight years" reference appeared in a question about the current warranty. OPEN Meaning and source to be confirmed (an accurate mapping of current Poland warranty terms is the prerequisite).
- **An extended warranty would help**, but per ch. 4 it must be built transparently into the requirements. Useful tender items: years, mileage cap, covered components (drivetrain, suspension, DPF / after-treatment), service conditions, business-use coverage.

11 Interior, Equipment, Connectivity and Fleet Monitoring

11.1 Interior and Seat Materials

- FIELD Crews get in with mud, snow, tools and dirty workwear as a matter of routine, so **interior durability matters**. Fabric seats stain, wear and are hard to clean; durable, easy-clean work materials are preferred. Isuzu mentioned a possible factory / R&D review of vinyl-type easy-clean seat materials.
- PROPOSAL Package durable upholstery, seat covers, rubber mats and easy-clean surfaces as a work-use interior specification for tenders.

11.2 Communication Equipment, Roof Fitment and Warranty

- FIELD The customer is considering additional communication systems — similar to firefighter operations — so field teams can reach each other, the office and support instantly during network incidents; a past serious incident with communication difficulty is the motivation. Roof-mounted antennas / communication devices may be needed.
- **Operationally necessary equipment should not create unreasonable warranty restrictions**, in the customer's expectation. OPEN Warranty impact of roof antennas, electrical modifications and conversions to be confirmed.

11.3 GPS / Fleet Monitoring

- FIELD All vehicles have GPS. Drivers log in, likely with a card, to operate the vehicle; the company can identify driver and vehicle use and monitor stationary engine running, fuel consumption and idle time.
- ANALYSIS This data can support analysis of real duty cycles, DPF risk, idling, fuel, maintenance and replacement planning — material for data-based TCO / DPF proposals.

12 EV Policy — Too Early for the Core Fleet

- FIELD **EVs are unsuitable for core field vehicles at present.** The reason is immediate readiness: in a network failure or emergency, vehicles must be available at any time and cannot wait one or two hours to charge. Charging in the field is an unacceptable risk for emergency network work.
- The company may run some EV passenger / office cars, but not the main operational fleet. Manufacturers often present EV options, but for field crews continuous availability, reliability and readiness come first.
- ANALYSIS Refrain from EV proposals for the core fleet and concentrate on the diesel 4x4 workhorse value. Note that regulatory separation (ch. 2) also prevents the company from operating charging businesses.

13 Priorities for Isuzu / Astara (6 items)

01 Win the ~150-unit tender first: prepare with Astara before publication; lead with price, reinforced by 10-year TCO, warranty and uptime to match public-procurement scoring.

02 Position as a non-Chinese diesel 4x4 workhorse: fits the protected segment; no EV proposals for the core fleet.

03 Cab line-up and work specification: keep Single / Extended Cab and prepare a work-use spec covering durable interior, load-bed storage and comms-equipment compatibility.

04 Keep manual, introduce AT via demos: manual is a must; automatic gradually, through loaded / off-road real-use demonstrations.

05 DPF / after-treatment support: countermeasures and service guidance for short-trip / long-idling use — directly tied to winning the business.

06 Tender execution basics: document quality (including translation) and stock / lead-time capability for year-end demand.

14 Next Actions

14.1 The ~150-Unit Tender (Top Priority)

- ACTION Continuous monitoring of the procurement platform by Astara Poland. After receiving the Focus Presentation, organise the price range and conditions so that **we can respond immediately once the tender is published**.
- ACTION Prepare the bid package in advance: Extended Cab specification and pricing, an extended warranty / service that can be written into the requirements, 10-year TCO material, document quality (including translation).
- ACTION Confirm the basics: the current brand mix of the operating fleet (L200, Ford, Toyota etc. against the 200+ D-MAX delivered), the legal entity of the visited branch, and delivery / stock capability (including year-end demand).

14.2 Items Owed to the Customer

- ACTION DPF / after-treatment: review countermeasures and service guidance for short-trip / long-idling use (the customer expects a response).
- ACTION Share the UK single-cab / conversion references (confirmed useful by the customer); check the feasibility of the small aerial platform (~3 units) within this.
- ACTION Answer on the warranty impact of roof antennas and communication equipment.

Other topics (manual / AT demonstration, work-use interior, parts pricing, etc.) will be handled only as needed as the tender takes shape.

This report organises the customer interview held at a PGE Group regional branch (field statements) according to the classification legend above. The customer's identity as PGE Group is confirmed; however, figures and items such as fleet size (~600 company-wide / ~107 at the branch), client numbers (~8–10 million) and the "eight years" warranty reference are the customer's statements and remain unverified. Follow-ups are managed as the ACTION items in ch. 14. To be read together with the previous day's Astara Poland visit report (Poland market / D-MAX business review, ch. 12 "PGE Group opportunity").

A Appendix — Post-Visit Update: PGE Tender Information and Current Actions

Following the PGE visit on 8 July 2026, the official tender documents and further details were shared by Mr. Radek of Astara Poland / IAP, and work on the opportunity is already under way. This appendix summarises the progress since the visit as a supplement to the report.

A-1 Tender Overview

- FACT Customer: PGE Dystrybucja S.A. / Scope: **173 pick-up trucks with body conversion** / Structure: **7 independent lots, separate contracts** (split: 33 / 24 / 26 / 25 / 23 / 26 / 16 units).
- Official offer deadline: **19 August 2026, 10:00** (offer opening 12:00 the same day). Evaluation is **100% price**, followed by an electronic reverse auction.
- Delivery: successive delivery within **9 months** from the signing date of each contract. Delay penalty: 0.3% of the net unit price per delayed vehicle per day, capped at 20%.

A-2 Vehicle Direction

- Preferred model: EC RBB, TEL7050 or TEL7051; **TEL7051 is preferred** due to the vinyl floor.
- Mandatory items are front fog lamps and steel wheels. The standard 18-inch steel wheels on TEL7050 / TEL7051 are acceptable.
- Options under study: (1) earlier factory / ML preparation for production between November 2026 and January 2027, (2) RBB with local installation of front fog lamps, (3) RBC TEL7054 with alloy wheels replaced by steel wheels.

A-3 Main Issues to Be Confirmed

- OPEN Final model and specification / feasible production timing in Thailand / shipment plan by lot / bodybuilder and conversion lead time in Poland / compliance with the 9-month delivery requirement / warranty and homologation treatment after local modification and body conversion / whether all 7 contracts will be signed at the same time or at different timings.

A-4 Pricing and Support

- IAP will calculate the preliminary target tender price.
- IAP will share the required level of fleet support after reviewing vehicle cost, body conversion cost, logistics cost, exchange-rate risk, electronic-auction pressure and contractual penalty risk.
- IMIT / IMIE will review possible fleet support after receiving IAP's target price and support request.

A-5 Indicative Earliest Schedule (example only)

Tender result	around mid-September 2026 at the earliest
Order to IMIT	September 2026
Production	December 2026
Shipment	January 2027
Arrival in Poland	April 2027
PDI and body conversion	May 2027
First-lot delivery to PGE	June 2027

This schedule appears feasible within 9 months if the relevant contract is signed around September 2026; the actual delivery plan must be checked against the signing date of each individual lot contract.

A-6 Current Status / Next Actions

- ACTION **IAP:** confirm the target tender price / confirm the required fleet support / review the full tender and bodybuilder requirements / clarify the expected contract-signing timing for each lot.
- ACTION **IMIT / IMCT:** confirm model feasibility / production timing / shipment plan by lot / the best execution route for front fog lamps and the wheel specification.
- ACTION **IMIE:** coordinate with IAP and IMIT / support the review of commercial conditions and fleet support.